03. Blossom Pass

Comet Cup · upgrade blueprint · src/kart/tracks/blossom.ts

Where it is now

3 km: lakeside village, red gates, hairpins to the summit temple, pagoda, descent or ridge road with a boost-only ravine jump, red bridge.

What is wrong

Pretty, but the driving is the same mix of bends and jumps as everywhere else.

Core mechanic

The drift mountain. This track is about drifting. Tight hairpins stacked down the mountain; long chained drifts build a bigger boost here than anywhere else (drift chains carry boost from one corner into the next).

Signature moments

- The stacked hairpins: you can see the cars on the bends below you and above you.
- A narrow ridge with no rails where a clean line is everything.
- A drift-chain gate: link five corners without breaking the drift and the gate at the bottom opens a short cut.

Layout changes

- Rebuild the descent as a true hairpin stack (8-10 hairpins).
- Keep the summit temple and pagoda as the top of the climb.
- Fewer jumps; the ravine jump stays as the one big moment.

Lap changes

- Lap 2: falling petals make the corners slick (less grip, longer drifts).
- Last lap: valley mist hides the apexes; lanterns mark the line.

Engine work needed

- Drift-chain boost (keep the drift charge across linked corners).
- Grip modifiers by lap (petal slick).
- A gate that opens on a condition (drift chain).

Rivals

- Rivals drift the hairpins (they need a drift line, not just a racing line).
- Rivals sometimes earn the drift-chain gate.

Done when

- Laps of 50-60 s for a good driver; all 3-lap test races finish with no errors.
- Rivals use every route and the core mechanic, with no more than 2 rival falls per race.
- The core mechanic is in play for at least half the lap, not just one set piece.
- A blind test: a screenshot or a 10-second clip of this track could not be mistaken for any other track.
- Item rows are never on the start line; nothing solid blocks a road by accident.